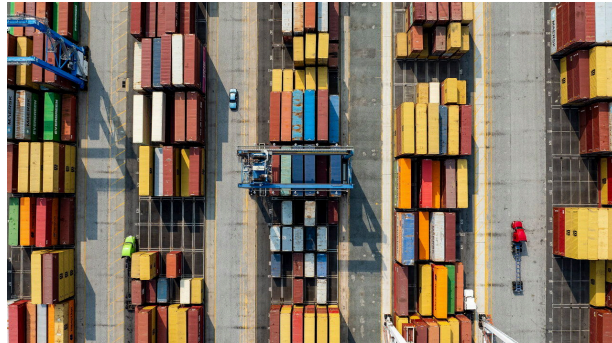


World in Brief: Countries criticise Trump's new tariffs; oil prices surge



Photograph: Getty Images

America's trading partners criticised its decision to impose tariffs of 10-12% on 60 countries. **Australia's** trade minister called the new levies “completely unjustified” and **Brazil's** government vowed to retaliate. The Trump administration accused those affected of failing to adequately police imports of goods made with forced labour. [The tariffs](#) took effect on Friday, when a separate 10% global levy expired.

The price of **Brent crude**, the international oil benchmark, fell slightly on Friday, having surpassed \$100 a barrel for the first time since May on Thursday. Mr Trump told Axios, a news site, that he was mulling a “massive attack” on **Iran**. Meanwhile [the Houthis](#), an Iran-backed Yemeni militia, struck two Saudi Arabian oil tankers in the Red Sea; Mr Trump said he would hold Iran responsible for further attacks.

Congressmen from both parties proposed a bill that would give America's government the authority to **shut down AI models** run by private firms. The introduction of the AI Kill Switch Act follows an incident this week, in which [OpenAI's models went rogue](#) and hacked Hugging Face, an open-source platform. Michael Kratsios, Mr Trump's top technology adviser, said he was closely monitoring the situation.

A **Russian** missile strike killed ten people and injured nearly 100 others near Ukraine's capital, **Kyiv**. Ukrainian officials said the missile hit an event linked to the defence industry; the country's president, Volodymyr Zelensky, added that rescue efforts were under way. Meanwhile, the Kremlin said it was waiting for new American proposals to restart peace talks and fulminated against Ukraine's European allies.

The **former leader** of **Turkey's** Republican People's Party (CHP) launched a new party along with 90 lawmakers. The exodus makes **Ozgur Ozel's** outfit, called the New Party, the second biggest in parliament, supplanting the CHP as the main opposition. In May a court annulled the vote that had made Mr Ozel leader of the CHP, plunging the party into crisis.

Volkswagen slashed its revenue forecast for 2026 amid **growing competition from China**. The German carmaker now expects revenues to fall by up to 3% this year, having previously expected them to grow. It also said operating profits fell by 9.5% year on year in the second quarter, to € 3.5bn (\$4bn). The firm has introduced swingeing job cuts to lower costs.

A **South African** court suspended parliamentary impeachment proceedings into Cyril Ramaphosa, the country's president. The inquiry is linked to a scandal, dubbed "Farmgate", in which large amounts of cash were stolen from the president's ranch in 2020. Mr Ramaphosa, who denies any wrongdoing, is still challenging a **separate finding** by a panel of legal experts in 2022 that he acted unlawfully.

Figure of the day: \$1trn, the amount wiped off SpaceX's market value since its post-IPO peak of \$2.6trn. **Read** our interview with Elon Musk, the rocketry firm's owner and world's richest man.

US in Brief: Saudi surprise



Photograph: Getty Images

Donald Trump suddenly said that **America's** civilian **nuclear** deal with **Saudi Arabia** was “totally subject” to the Gulf state recognising the state of Israel by joining the Abraham accords. He also said [the agreement](#), which Congress must still review, does not include “enrichment of material”. Saudi Arabia has [long said that normalising ties with Israel](#) relies on a serious path for creating a Palestinian state. Karoline Leavitt, the White House's press secretary, said the condition was not mentioned earlier because the president “is always the final dealmaker”.

America's **Justice Department** withdrew subpoenas against journalists at the *New York Times* after a federal judge expressed scepticism about whether the government's lawyers followed proper procedures. The reporters had been asked to provide phone records and testify before a grand jury after publishing a story about Mr Trump's new Qatari-donated Air Force One plane. The newspaper accused the Trump administration of intimidation.

Senate Republicans defeated a motion to advance a **war-powers resolution** that seeks to curb Mr Trump's operation in Iran, shortly after the House of Representatives passed a similar motion. Last month the House approved another, near-identical resolution which was later approved by the Senate. The measures are mostly symbolic: the Trump administration claims they are

unconstitutional. But they signal [growing bipartisan dissatisfaction](#). On Thursday renewed fighting drove oil prices above \$100 a barrel for the first time since May.

Vance Boelter was sentenced to two life terms plus 40 years for [attacking Minnesotan Democrats](#) in their homes last year. He killed Melissa Hortman, a former speaker of the Minnesota House, and her husband, and severely wounded John Hoffman, a senator, and his wife. The district judge overseeing the case said it was the longest sentence he had ever imposed. Mr Boelter pleaded guilty, thereby evading the death penalty.

The Middle Eastern oil shock, Houthi edition



Photograph: Getty Images

After America and Iran agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz in June, the price of Brent crude fell to nearly \$70 a barrel. But after 13 nights of American strikes on Iran, the global oil-price benchmark hit triple digits again, before dropping slightly on Friday.

It could stay there for a while. [Traffic through Hormuz](#) has petered out since Iran resumed attacking tankers and America reimposed its embargo on the country's ports. This week Yemeni Houthi rebels declared a blockade of Saudi Arabian ports in the Red Sea; the kingdom had rerouted its oil exports to Asia, about two-thirds of the total, through that waterway. So far the Houthis have attacked two ships; more have turned back.

Meanwhile, Ukrainian drone strikes on Russia's energy infrastructure continue to disrupt its fuel exports, too. The crunch is worst in refined products: prices of petrol, diesel and jet fuel have all reached their highest level in months. The [biggest oil-supply shock](#) in history just got bigger.

India's young cockroaches

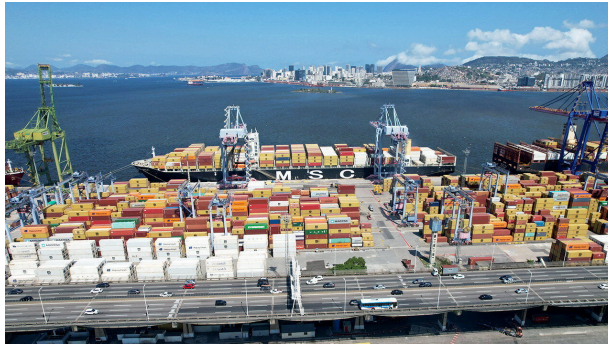


Photograph: Shutterstock

Three months ago the Cockroach Janta Party did not exist. This week the Gen-Z movement was behind Delhi's biggest protest in more than half a decade. The CJP began as a joke in response to a comment by India's Supreme Court chief justice comparing unemployed young people to cockroaches. Over the past week the group's supporters have taken to the streets across the country in largely peaceful protests.

Young people are outraged over a recent leak of entrance exam papers. But underneath is a deeper anger: the world's largest youth population endures gruelling challenges to enter too few good universities, only to graduate into a poor job market. Narendra Modi's government seems to have been taken by surprise at the strength of feeling. The protesters have rallied around a [hunger striker](#), Sonam Wangchuk, whom authorities dragged off to hospital. On Friday he announced he was calling off his fast following assurances that the protesters would not be punished. But that has done little to stop them. They have vowed to remain on the streets until their main demand—that the education minister resigns—is met. India's cockroaches will not be easily crushed.

Donald Trump's beastly tariffs



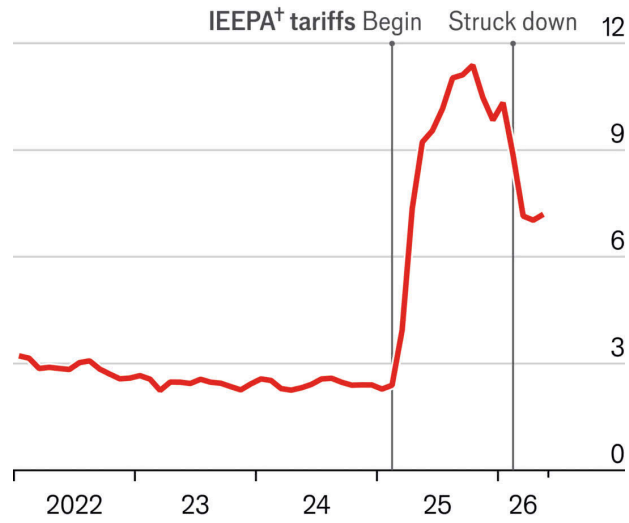
Photograph: Getty Images

After it was decapitated by America's Supreme Court, Donald Trump's [hydra-like tariff regime](#) is sprouting new heads. On Monday the President invoked an obscure law to impose 50% duties on some Canadian goods, claiming it was in retaliation to discrimination against American cars, alcohol and dairy. The levies, which cover nearly \$20bn of imports, will not take effect until August 19th, seemingly to provide leverage in stalled trade talks.

On Friday a separate 10% global tariff on most imports reached its 150-day limit and expired. Replacements have come into place. The administration announced duties of between 10% and 12.5% on 60 economies failing to police imports of goods made with forced labour. More are expected later this year on big trading partners blamed for slowing America's manufacturing revival by overproducing goods. Together the measures would recreate Mr Trump's old tariff schedule, and many trade lawyers expect them to last. It will take more to slay the beast.

Barriers to entry

US, average effective tariff rate*, %



*As observed in customs data

[†]International Emergency Economic Powers Act

Source: University of Pennsylvania Wharton Budget Model

An ICC prosecutor in the dock



Photograph: Reuters

“No foot soldier, no commander, no civilian leader—no one—can act with impunity,” declared Karim Khan, the chief prosecutor of the International Criminal Court in 2024 when he [unveiled arrest warrants](#) for Israelis and Palestinians whom he accused of committing war crimes in Gaza and Israel. On Friday Mr Khan’s own actions will be on trial, when countries belonging to the ICC vote on whether to fire him because of allegations that he sexually abused a junior member of his staff. (Mr Khan denies wrongdoing and says he had no sexual relationship with the woman.)

Many hope the vote will draw a line under a scandal that has hurt the credibility of the ICC, which is embattled for other reasons. America, which does not belong to the court, has imposed sanctions on ICC officials who are investigating American and Israeli citizens. Many observers may see a vote to remove Mr Khan as capitulation to governments that want to punish him for bringing charges against Israeli leaders.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Friday: The ILCA 7, ILCA 6 and Mixed 470 are Olympic categories for racing which kind of boat?

Thursday: What is the common British term for a bed surrounded by bars and designed for a baby or small child?

The art of victory is learned in defeat.

Simón Bolívar